



IN APRIL, EYEWEAR retailer Lenskart apologised publicly to quieten a furore over its internal grooming guidelines that appeared to frown on employees sporting Hindu religious symbols like *bindis* and *tilaks*.

Around the same time, software services firm Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) was caught at the perilous intersection of religious identity, coercion and alleged sexual harassment in a scandal at its Nashik back office.

Lenskart's leaked in-house grooming guide was outdated, responded the company, which clarified that it "unambiguously" welcomed all symbols of faith worn by employees. These include *bindis*, *tilaks*, *mangalsutras* (Hindu), *hijabs* (Muslim), turbans and *kadas* (Sikh).

Sure, Lenskart and TCS are entirely different kinds of companies. Lenskart is a fledgling consumer-facing business that sells eyewear to individuals online and in physical stores; TCS is a part of the giant Tata